

NEXATECH SOLUTIONS LTD

Comprehensive Workplace Policies & Procedures

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This handbook contains confidential policies and procedures applicable to all employees of NexaTech Solutions Ltd. It supersedes all previous versions. Employees are responsible for reading, understanding, and complying with all policies contained herein.

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SECTION 1

Remote Work & Flexible Working Policy

NexaTech Solutions Ltd recognises that flexible and remote working arrangements can improve employee wellbeing, increase productivity, and support a healthy work-life balance. This policy sets out the framework under which employees may work remotely and the responsibilities that accompany this flexibility.

1.1 Eligibility & Approval Process

Remote working is available to all permanent employees who have successfully completed their 3-month probationary period. Contractors, agency workers, and employees on fixed-term contracts of less than 6 months are not eligible for the standard remote working arrangement unless an exception is approved by their Head of Department.

To apply for a remote working arrangement, employees must complete a Remote Work Application Form (Form HR-22) and submit it to their line manager at least 10 working days before the intended start date. Applications will be assessed against the following criteria:

- The nature of the role and whether it can be effectively performed remotely
- The employee's performance record over the preceding 6 months
- Team structure and the operational needs of the business unit
- Home working environment suitability (assessed via self-declaration form)
- Data security and regulatory compliance requirements for the role

Standard Remote Working Arrangements
• Full Remote: Up to 5 days/week remote — requires VP-level approval • Hybrid (Standard): 2–3 days remote per week — line manager approval • Hybrid (Occasional): Up to 1 day remote per week — informal agreement • Temporary Remote: Up to 4 weeks — manager approval; no formal application required

1.2 Equipment & Home Office Standards

NexaTech will provide the following standard equipment to employees approved for hybrid or full remote arrangements: a laptop (15" or 13" depending on role), a laptop stand, a USB-C docking station, and a wired keyboard and mouse. Employees working remotely for more than 3 days per week are also entitled to a 24" monitor upon request, subject to availability.

Employees are responsible for ensuring their home working environment meets the following minimum standards:

- A dedicated workspace that is free from distractions during core working hours
- A reliable broadband internet connection with a minimum speed of 25 Mbps download

- A private, lockable space for handling confidential documents or sensitive calls
- Adequate lighting and an ergonomic seating arrangement (see Section 7.4)

1.3 Core Hours & Availability Requirements

All employees working remotely must be available and responsive during core hours of **09:30 to 16:30 GMT/BST**, regardless of their full contracted hours. Outside of core hours, employees are encouraged to manage their schedules flexibly, provided this does not impact team collaboration or client commitments.

Role Band	Core Hours	Max Remote Days	Approval Level
Band 1–3 (Junior)	09:30–16:30	2 days/week	Line Manager
Band 4–6 (Mid)	09:30–16:30	3 days/week	Line Manager
Band 7–9 (Senior)	09:00–17:00	4 days/week	Head of Dept
Band 10+ (Lead/Principal)	Flexible	5 days/week	VP Approval

1.4 Data Security When Working Remotely

Employees working remotely must adhere to all requirements outlined in Section 6 (Data Protection & Information Security). Specific obligations when working away from a NexaTech office include:

- Always connecting to company systems via the NexaTech VPN (GlobalProtect) — no exceptions
- Never using public Wi-Fi networks without the VPN active
- Locking the screen when stepping away from the device (Windows + L / Cmd + Ctrl + Q)
- Not printing confidential documents on personal printers; use secure print facilities at a NexaTech office
- Storing all work files on approved cloud storage (SharePoint/OneDrive) — never local drives only

Policy Breach Notice: Failure to comply with remote working data security requirements may result in immediate suspension of remote working privileges and may constitute a disciplinary matter under Section 8 of this handbook.

SECTION 2

Code of Conduct & Professional Standards

NexaTech Solutions Ltd expects all employees to conduct themselves with the highest standards of integrity, professionalism, and respect. This section defines the behaviours expected of all employees and the actions that NexaTech will take when these standards are not met.

2.1 Workplace Behaviour Standards

All employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, contractors, and visitors with dignity and respect, regardless of their role, seniority, or background. Bullying, harassment, and discrimination of any kind are strictly prohibited and will be treated as gross misconduct.

- Treat all individuals with respect and professionalism at all times
- Speak up if you witness inappropriate behaviour — silence can enable misconduct
- Use inclusive language in all communications, written and verbal
- Respect confidentiality — do not discuss personal matters of colleagues externally
- Report concerns to People & Culture (people@nexatech.com) or via the anonymous Speak Up line

2.2 Social Media & External Communications

Employees may engage with social media in a personal capacity, but must be mindful that public statements can reflect upon NexaTech. The following rules apply to all external communications including social media, blog posts, conference presentations, and media interviews:

- Never disclose confidential company information, client data, or unreleased product details
- Do not make statements that could be interpreted as official NexaTech positions without PR approval
- Clearly distinguish personal opinions from official company views when discussing industry topics
- Do not post content that is defamatory, harassing, discriminatory, or brings the company into disrepute
- All media interview requests must be directed to communications@nexatech.com for prior approval

2.3 Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when a personal interest has the potential — or appearance of potential — to influence professional decision-making. All actual and potential conflicts must be disclosed to your line manager and documented via the Conflict of Interest Register (Form HR-08). Common examples include:

- Being involved in procurement decisions where a family member or close associate works for a supplier
- Holding a financial interest (shares, directorship) in a competitor or supplier organisation
- Undertaking outside employment or consulting work that competes with NexaTech's business

- Participating in hiring decisions for a candidate with whom you have a personal relationship

2.4 Gifts, Hospitality & Anti-Bribery

NexaTech maintains a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption in line with the UK Bribery Act 2010. Employees must not offer, accept, or request gifts, payments, or hospitality that could influence or appear to influence business decisions.

Item	Threshold	Action Required
Token gifts (pens, chocolates, branded items)	Under £25	May accept; no registration required
Gifts / hospitality	£25–£100	Must register in Gifts Register (Form HR-12)
Significant gifts / sponsored events	Over £100	Manager + Finance approval required before accepting
Cash or cash equivalents	Any amount	Never acceptable — must decline and report

SECTION 3

Annual Leave & Time-Off Policy

3.1 Annual Leave Entitlement

NexaTech provides a competitive annual leave allowance that increases with tenure. All full-time employees receive a minimum of 25 days of annual leave per year plus UK public holidays. Part-time employees receive leave on a pro-rata basis.

Service Length	Annual Leave (days)	Public Holidays	Total
0–2 years	25	8	33
2–5 years	27	8	35
5–10 years	30	8	38
10+ years	33	8	41

3.2 Booking & Approval Process

All annual leave must be requested and approved via the Workday HR system. The following notice periods apply:

- **1–3 days:** Minimum 5 working days' notice required
- **4–9 days:** Minimum 10 working days' notice required
- **10+ days (including extended travel):** Minimum 4 weeks' notice required
- **Over Christmas/New Year (23 Dec – 2 Jan):** Must be booked by 1 October of that year

Important: Managers are expected to approve or decline leave requests within 3 working days. If a request is declined, the manager must provide a written reason. Employees may appeal declined requests to the People & Culture team.

3.3 Bank Holidays & Public Holidays

All UK public holidays are included in the leave entitlement above and are not taken from the annual leave allowance. Employees who are required to work on a public holiday (e.g. on-call support staff) will receive time off in lieu at 1.5× rate, to be taken within 3 months.

3.4 Carrying Over Leave

NexaTech strongly encourages employees to take their full annual leave entitlement each year. The following carry-over rules apply for the leave year running 1 January to 31 December:

- **Standard carry-over:** Up to 5 days may be carried forward to the following leave year, to be used by 31 March
- **Sickness absence:** Where leave could not be taken due to long-term sick leave, up to 20 days may be carried forward

- **Shared Parental / Maternity / Paternity Leave:** Statutory leave that prevented holiday from being taken may be carried forward in full
- **Business-critical carry-over:** Where a manager required an employee to cancel approved leave, those days will be carried forward without restriction

SECTION 4

Performance Management Policy

NexaTech operates a continuous performance management framework designed to support employee growth, recognise high performance, and address underperformance constructively and at the earliest opportunity.

4.1 Performance Review Cycle

Formal performance reviews occur twice per year: a mid-year check-in in June/July and an end-of-year review in November/December. Both reviews are conducted in Workday and involve self-assessment by the employee, assessment by the line manager, and a calibration discussion within the business unit.

4.2 Goal Setting & OKR Framework

NexaTech uses Objectives and Key Results (OKRs) for goal setting at company, team, and individual levels. Individual OKRs are set at the start of each half-year and should meet the following criteria:

- **Objectives:** 3–5 qualitative goals per half-year that are ambitious but achievable
- **Key Results:** 2–4 measurable outcomes per objective with clear success criteria
- **Alignment:** Individual OKRs must connect to at least one team-level OKR
- **Stretch:** At least one KR per employee should represent a genuine stretch target

4.3 Underperformance Procedure

Where performance concerns arise, managers are expected to address them early and informally before initiating a formal process. The underperformance procedure follows three stages:

Stage	Process	Duration	Support Provided
Stage 1 Informal	Verbal feedback and coaching from manager; documented in 1:1 notes	4–6 weeks	Manager coaching; L&D resources
Stage 2 PIP	Formal Performance Improvement Plan with specific targets and review dates	8–12 weeks	HR business partner; mentor allocation
Stage 3 Formal Review	Formal hearing if PIP targets not met; may result in dismissal or redeployment	2–4 weeks	Right to be accompanied; HR present

4.4 Promotion & Progression Criteria

Promotions at NexaTech are merit-based and assessed against the NexaTech Career Framework. To be considered for promotion to the next band, an employee must typically meet all of the following criteria:

- Be operating consistently at the level above their current band for a minimum of 6 months

- Have received a 'Meets Expectations' or above rating in both of their last two performance reviews
- Have no active disciplinary warnings on record
- Have their line manager's endorsement and a calibrated recommendation from the business unit head
- Have completed any mandatory role-specific training for the target band

SECTION 5

Expenses & Reimbursement Policy

NexaTech will reimburse employees for reasonable and necessary business expenses incurred in the performance of their duties. All expenses must be submitted with appropriate receipts within 30 days of the expense being incurred, via the Expensify system.

5.1 Travel Expenses

Business travel should always represent the most economical and practical option consistent with the purpose of the trip. Employees are expected to book travel at least 14 days in advance where possible to obtain the best available fares.

Travel Type	Policy	Limit / Guidance
Rail (UK)	Standard class; first class only if journey > 3 hours and booked for working purposes	Book via Trainline business account
Air (UK domestic)	Economy only; permitted where rail journey > 4 hours	Pre-approval by manager required
Air (International)	Economy; business class permitted for flights > 6 hours with VP approval	Book at least 3 weeks in advance
Taxi / Ride-share	When public transport is impractical or journey is outside core hours	£50 per trip cap; receipt required
Personal car	Reimbursed at HMRC approved mileage rate	45p/mile first 10,000 miles; 25p/mile thereafter

5.2 Subsistence & Meals

Subsistence expenses are reimbursable when an employee is required to be away from their usual place of work for the purposes of a business trip. The following daily limits apply:

- **Breakfast:** Up to £10 (claimable only if departing before 07:00)
- **Lunch:** Up to £15 (claimable only if away from usual work location for more than 4 hours during the midday period)
- **Dinner:** Up to £30 (claimable only if returning home after 20:00 or staying overnight)
- **Overnight accommodation (UK cities):** Up to £175 per night including breakfast
- **Overnight accommodation (London):** Up to £220 per night including breakfast
- **Overnight accommodation (international):** Reasonable; band-appropriate hotel

5.3 Equipment & Technology Purchases

Software subscriptions, hardware, and other technology purchases require prior approval before purchase. The following approval thresholds apply:

- **Under £100:** Line manager email approval sufficient; submit receipt with approval email

- **£100–£500:** Line manager + Finance Business Partner approval via procurement@nexatech.com
- **Over £500:** Formal purchase order required; contact Finance before purchase
- **Annual SaaS subscriptions:** All new software tools must go through IT Security review regardless of cost

5.4 Submission Deadlines & Approval Limits

Expenses must be submitted within **30 calendar days** of the date the expense was incurred. Expenses submitted after 30 days may be declined. End-of-year expenses must be submitted by **15 December** to ensure processing within the financial year. Expenses submitted without receipts over £10 will not be reimbursed.

SECTION 6

Data Protection & Information Security

NexaTech is a data processor and controller subject to the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018. All employees are responsible for handling personal and confidential data in accordance with these regulations and the company's Data Protection Policy.

6.1 GDPR Obligations for Employees

Every employee who handles personal data as part of their role must complete annual GDPR awareness training via the NexaTech Learning Portal. Core obligations include:

- Only collect and process personal data for a specific, documented, and lawful purpose
- Store personal data only for as long as necessary and in line with the Data Retention Schedule
- Never share personal data externally without confirming the recipient has appropriate safeguards
- Respect data subject rights including access requests, correction requests, and erasure requests
- Complete a Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) before launching any new process involving personal data

6.2 Acceptable Use of Company Systems

NexaTech's IT systems — including email, devices, cloud storage, communication tools, and the company network — are provided for business use. Limited personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work or breach this policy.

Prohibited Activities on Company Systems
• Accessing, downloading, or distributing illegal, offensive, or inappropriate content • Installing unauthorised software or browser extensions without IT approval • Sharing company credentials or using others' credentials to access systems • Using company email for personal business ventures or commercial activities • Attempting to circumvent security controls, firewalls, or monitoring systems • Using AI/LLM tools to process confidential client data without DPO sign-off

6.3 Data Breach Reporting Procedure

A personal data breach is any security incident that leads to accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, alteration, or disclosure of personal data. All suspected breaches **must be reported within 1 hour of discovery** by emailing security@nexatech.com and calling the IT Security Hotline on ext. 4444.

NexaTech is legally required to notify the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) within 72 hours of becoming aware of a breach that poses a risk to individuals. Delayed reporting by employees may result in regulatory fines and disciplinary action.

6.4 Retention & Disposal of Data

Data must be retained for only as long as is legally necessary or operationally required. The full Data Retention Schedule is available on the company intranet. Key retention periods for common data categories are:

Data Type	Retention Period	Disposal Method
Employee records (active)	Duration of employment + 6 years	Secure deletion from Workday
Payroll records	7 years post-employment	Encrypted archive then deletion
CCTV footage	31 days	Auto-overwrite
Client contracts	7 years post-contract end	Secure shredding / deletion
Interview records (unsuccessful)	6 months from decision	Delete from ATS

SECTION 7

Health, Safety & Wellbeing

7.1 Workplace Safety Responsibilities

NexaTech is committed to providing a safe and healthy working environment. All employees have a legal duty to take reasonable care of their own health and safety and that of others who may be affected by their actions. Each NexaTech office has a designated Health & Safety Representative whose contact details are posted at each building reception.

7.2 Mental Health & Employee Assistance Programme

NexaTech believes that mental health is as important as physical health. All employees have access to the Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) which provides free, confidential support 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. The EAP can be accessed by calling **0800 246 1234** or via the online portal at eap.nexatech.com.

- **Counselling:** Up to 8 sessions of structured counselling per issue, per year
- **Financial guidance:** Debt management, budgeting, and financial planning advice
- **Legal helpline:** 30-minute consultations with qualified solicitors
- **Manager support:** Guidance for managers dealing with team members in distress
- **Mental Health First Aiders:** Trained volunteers in each office — names listed on the intranet

7.3 Sick Leave & Return-to-Work

NexaTech operates an occupational sick pay scheme that is more generous than the statutory minimum. Sick pay entitlements based on length of service are as follows:

Service	Full Pay	Half Pay
0–6 months	1 week	1 week
6 months–2 years	4 weeks	4 weeks
2–5 years	8 weeks	8 weeks
5+ years	13 weeks	13 weeks

A return-to-work interview will be conducted by the line manager after every period of sickness absence, regardless of length. Following absence of more than 4 consecutive weeks, a phased return-to-work plan will be developed with support from Occupational Health.

7.4 Ergonomics & DSE Assessments

All employees who use display screen equipment (DSE) as a significant part of their work must complete a DSE self-assessment via the NexaTech Learning Portal within their first 4 weeks of employment and annually thereafter. Employees working from home are required to complete a separate Home Workstation Assessment (Form HS-07).

SECTION 8

Disciplinary & Grievance Procedure

8.1 Informal Resolution

In many cases, concerns about conduct or capability can and should be resolved informally through a direct conversation between the employee and their manager. Managers are encouraged to address issues early, before they escalate. A note of informal discussions should be kept by the manager but will not be placed on the employee's formal record.

8.2 Formal Disciplinary Process

Where informal resolution is not appropriate or has not been successful, NexaTech will follow a formal disciplinary procedure that complies with the ACAS Code of Practice. The procedure consists of the following stages:

- **Investigation:** An impartial investigating manager will gather evidence and interview relevant parties
- **Written notification:** The employee will receive written notice of the allegations and the hearing date (minimum 5 working days' notice)
- **Disciplinary hearing:** The employee may be accompanied by a colleague or trade union representative
- **Decision and outcome:** One of: no further action, first written warning, final written warning, or dismissal
- **Appeal:** The employee has the right to appeal any formal outcome within 5 working days

8.3 Grounds for Summary Dismissal

The following examples constitute gross misconduct and may result in immediate dismissal without notice or payment in lieu of notice. This list is illustrative, not exhaustive:

- Theft, fraud, or deliberate falsification of company records or expense claims
- Physical assault or threatening behaviour toward a colleague, client, or visitor
- Serious breach of data protection obligations resulting in, or risking, significant harm
- Deliberate misuse or destruction of company property or IT systems
- Being under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs while at work or operating company vehicles
- Serious harassment, bullying, or discrimination
- Unauthorised disclosure of confidential company or client information

8.4 Grievance Procedure & Appeals

Any employee who has a concern or complaint about their working conditions, treatment, or the conduct of a colleague or manager may raise a formal grievance. The process is as follows:

- **Step 1 — Informal:** Raise with line manager or, if that is not appropriate, with the People & Culture team

- **Step 2 — Formal written grievance:** Submit a written grievance to people@nexatech.com
- **Step 3 — Grievance hearing:** Conducted by a manager not involved in the matter, within 10 working days of receipt
- **Step 4 — Outcome:** Written outcome issued within 5 working days of the hearing
- **Step 5 — Appeal:** Right of appeal to a more senior manager within 5 working days of outcome

Policy Review & Acknowledgement

This Employee Policy Handbook is reviewed annually by the People & Culture team. The most recent version is always available on the NexaTech intranet at intranet.nexatech.com/policies. All employees are required to confirm their acknowledgement of this handbook via the Workday HR system within 14 days of its publication or any material update.

For questions about any policy in this handbook, contact: people@nexatech.com